

LESSON SEVEN

CROSS

Learning to Hate Sin and Love God Through Jesus' Sacrifice

PURPOSE

**To hate sin and love God
because we appreciate
Jesus' sacrifice.**

**How would you
define sacrifice?**

Who would you die for?

The Cross is the foundation of Christianity.

Sin hurts both God and us. Jesus was fully God and fully human, and He experienced real sorrow, struggle, pain, rejection, and suffering.

How do you truly view the Cross?

Before we open the Bible

How would you define
sacrifice?

Who would you die for?

Hold both answers next to each other. The first one is a definition. The second one is a list, and it is almost always short.

MATTHEW 26:31–35 NIV

³¹ Then Jesus told them, “This very night you will all fall away on account of me, for it is written:

“I will strike the shepherd,
and the sheep of the flock will be scattered.’

³² But after I have risen, I will go ahead of you into Galilee.” ³³ Peter replied, “Even if all fall away on account of you, I never will.” ³⁴ “Truly I tell you,” Jesus answered, “this very night, before the rooster crows, you will disown me three times.” ³⁵ But Peter declared, “Even if I have to die with you, I will never disown you.” And all the other disciples said the same.

ACTS 242 SUMMARY

Jesus told His disciples they would all fall away that night, and He told Peter he would deny Him three times. In Gethsemane, Jesus was deeply troubled and prayed three times, submitting to the Father's will. Meanwhile, the disciples kept falling asleep instead of watching and praying. Finally, Jesus said the time had come for Him to be betrayed.

UNDERSTAND

Jesus did not go to the Cross lightly. He felt the weight of what was coming. Obedience can involve deep struggle, and prayer gave Jesus strength to endure.

Jesus did not simply die. He chose to surrender Himself to the will of the Father.

Arrested, and Deserted

MATTHEW 26:47-68 NIV

VERSES 47 TO 50

⁴⁷ While he was still speaking, Judas, one of the Twelve, arrived. With him was a large crowd armed with swords and clubs, sent from the chief priests and the elders of the people. ⁴⁸ Now the betrayer had arranged a signal with them: “The one I kiss is the man; arrest him.” ⁴⁹ Going at once to Jesus, Judas said, “Greetings, Rabbi!” and kissed him. ⁵⁰ Jesus replied, “Do what you came for, friend.” Then the men stepped forward, seized Jesus and arrested him.

Put Your Sword Back

MATTHEW 26:47–68 NIV

VERSES 51 TO 56

⁵¹ With that, one of Jesus' companions reached for his sword, drew it out and struck the servant of the high priest, cutting off his ear. ⁵² "Put your sword back in its place," Jesus said to him, "for all who draw the sword will die by the sword. ⁵³ Do you think I cannot call on my Father, and he will at once put at my disposal more than twelve legions of angels? ⁵⁴ But how then would the Scriptures be fulfilled that say it must happen in this way?" ⁵⁵ In that hour Jesus said to the crowd, "Am I leading a rebellion, that you have come out with swords and clubs to capture me? Every day I sat in the temple courts teaching, and you did not arrest me. ⁵⁶ But this has all taken place that the writings of the prophets might be fulfilled." Then all the disciples deserted him and fled.

Before the High Priest

MATTHEW 26:47–68 NIV

VERSES 57 TO 61

⁵⁷ Those who had arrested Jesus took him to Caiaphas the high priest, where the teachers of the law and the elders had assembled. ⁵⁸ But Peter followed him at a distance, right up to the courtyard of the high priest. He entered and sat down with the guards to see the outcome. ⁵⁹ The chief priests and the whole Sanhedrin were looking for false evidence against Jesus so that they could put him to death. ⁶⁰ But they did not find any, though many false witnesses came forward. Finally two came forward ⁶¹ and declared, “This fellow said, ‘I am able to destroy the temple of God and rebuild it in three days.’”

Are You the Messiah?

MATTHEW 26:47–68 NIV

VERSES 62 TO 68

⁶² Then the high priest stood up and said to Jesus, “Are you not going to answer? What is this testimony that these men are bringing against you?” ⁶³ But Jesus remained silent. The high priest said to him, “I charge you under oath by the living God: Tell us if you are the Messiah, the Son of God.” ⁶⁴ “You have said so,” Jesus replied. “But I say to all of you: From now on you will see the Son of Man sitting at the right hand of the Mighty One and coming on the clouds of heaven.” ⁶⁵ Then the high priest tore his clothes and said, “He has spoken blasphemy! Why do we need any more witnesses? Look, now you have heard the blasphemy. ⁶⁶ What do you think?” “He is worthy of death,” they answered. ⁶⁷ Then they spit in his face and struck him with their fists. Others slapped him ⁶⁸ and said, “Prophecy to us, Messiah. Who hit you?”

ACTS 242 SUMMARY

Judas came with an armed crowd and betrayed Jesus with a kiss, and Jesus was arrested. When one disciple tried to defend Him with a sword, Jesus stopped him and said this had to happen to fulfill Scripture. All the disciples then deserted Him and fled. Jesus was taken before the high priest and the Sanhedrin, where false witnesses accused Him. When asked if He was the Messiah, Jesus answered boldly, and they condemned Him to death, mocked Him, spat on Him, and struck Him.

UNDERSTAND

Jesus had the power to escape, but He chose the Cross. His suffering was voluntary, His arrest was not weakness, and His love was intentional.

ASK

Peter followed, but from a distance. How does that relate to you?

THREE RESPONSES

To the Cross

Peter. Judas. Pilate.

PETER

MATTHEW 26:69-75

Peter denied Jesus. Out of fear, he disowned Him, but afterward he was deeply broken and wept bitterly.

SHOWS Cowardice, but also godly sorrow.

JUDAS

MATTHEW 27:1-10

Judas betrayed Jesus, realized his sin, but gave in to worldly sorrow and took his own life.

SHOWS Betrayal and worldly sorrow.

PILATE

MATTHEW 27:11-26

Pilate failed to stand for what was right. His indecision was still a decision, and he cared more about people's opinions than God's truth.

SHOWS Indecision and fear of people.

The Cross forces every person to respond. No response is also a response.

ASK

**Which response are
you most like: Peter,
Judas, or Pilate?**

The Crucifixion

MATTHEW 27:27-56 NIV

VERSES 27 TO 31

²⁷ Then the governor's soldiers took Jesus into the Praetorium and gathered the whole company of soldiers around him. ²⁸ They stripped him and put a scarlet robe on him, ²⁹ and then twisted together a crown of thorns and set it on his head. They put a staff in his right hand. Then they knelt in front of him and mocked him. "Hail, king of the Jews!" they said. ³⁰ They spit on him, and took the staff and struck him on the head again and again. ³¹ After they had mocked him, they took off the robe and put his own clothes on him. Then they led him away to crucify him.

³² As they were going out, they met a man from Cyrene, named Simon, and they forced him to carry the cross. ³³ They came to a place called Golgotha (which means “the place of the skull”). ³⁴ There they offered Jesus wine to drink, mixed with gall; but after tasting it, he refused to drink it. ³⁵ When they had crucified him, they divided up his clothes by casting lots. ³⁶ And sitting down, they kept watch over him there. ³⁷ Above his head they placed the written charge against him: THIS IS JESUS, THE KING OF THE JEWS.

³⁸ Two rebels were crucified with him, one on his right and one on his left. ³⁹ Those who passed by hurled insults at him, shaking their heads ⁴⁰ and saying, “You who are going to destroy the temple and build it in three days, save yourself! Come down from the cross, if you are the Son of God!” ⁴¹ In the same way the chief priests, the teachers of the law and the elders mocked him. ⁴² “He saved others,” they said, “but he can’t save himself! He’s the king of Israel! Let him come down now from the cross, and we will believe in him. ⁴³ He trusts in God. Let God rescue him now if he wants him, for he said, ‘I am the Son of God.’” ⁴⁴ In the same way the rebels who were crucified with him also heaped insults on him.

He Gave Up His Spirit

MATTHEW 27:27-56 NIV

VERSES 45 TO 50

⁴⁵ From noon until three in the afternoon darkness came over all the land. ⁴⁶ About three in the afternoon Jesus cried out in a loud voice, “Eli, Eli, lema sabachthani?” (which means “My God, my God, why have you forsaken me?”). ⁴⁷ When some of those standing there heard this, they said, “He’s calling Elijah.” ⁴⁸ Immediately one of them ran and got a sponge. He filled it with wine vinegar, put it on a staff, and offered it to Jesus to drink. ⁴⁹ The rest said, “Now leave him alone. Let’s see if Elijah comes to save him.” ⁵⁰ And when Jesus had cried out again in a loud voice, he gave up his spirit.

The Curtain Was Torn

MATTHEW 27:27-56 NIV

VERSES 51 TO 56

⁵¹ At that moment the curtain of the temple was torn in two from top to bottom. The earth shook, the rocks split ⁵² and the tombs broke open. The bodies of many holy people who had died were raised to life. ⁵³ They came out of the tombs after Jesus' resurrection and went into the holy city and appeared to many people. ⁵⁴ When the centurion and those with him who were guarding Jesus saw the earthquake and all that had happened, they were terrified, and exclaimed, "Surely he was the Son of God!" ⁵⁵ Many women were there, watching from a distance. They had followed Jesus from Galilee to care for his needs. ⁵⁶ Among them were Mary Magdalene, Mary the mother of James and Joseph, and the mother of Zebedee's sons.

ACTS 242 SUMMARY

The soldiers mocked Jesus, put a robe and crown of thorns on Him, and led Him away to be crucified. At Golgotha, Jesus was crucified, mocked by the crowd, religious leaders, and even the rebels beside Him. Darkness covered the land, and Jesus cried out before giving up His spirit. At His death, the temple curtain was torn, the earth shook, and many were terrified. Seeing all this, the centurion declared that Jesus truly was the Son of God.

UNDERSTAND

The Cross shows both the seriousness of sin and the greatness of God's love. Jesus suffered publicly, painfully, willingly, and in our place.

**He took what we
deserved so that we
could receive what only
He could give.**

He Became Sin For Us

2 CORINTHIANS 5:21 NIV

21 God made him who had no sin to be sin for us, so that in him we might become the righteousness of God.

This is the exchange at the centre of the Cross. He took our guilt, and gave us a standing before God that was never ours to earn. Nothing in the trade was fair, and none of it was accidental.

The Cross Is Not the End

MATTHEW 27:57-66 NIV

VERSES 57 TO 61

⁵⁷ As evening approached, there came a rich man from Arimathea, named Joseph, who had himself become a disciple of Jesus. ⁵⁸ Going to Pilate, he asked for Jesus' body, and Pilate ordered that it be given to him. ⁵⁹ Joseph took the body, wrapped it in a clean linen cloth, ⁶⁰ and placed it in his own new tomb that he had cut out of the rock. He rolled a big stone in front of the entrance to the tomb and went away. ⁶¹ Mary Magdalene and the other Mary were sitting there opposite the tomb.

The Tomb Made Secure

MATTHEW 27:57-66 NIV

VERSES 62 TO 66

⁶² The next day, the one after Preparation Day, the chief priests and the Pharisees went to Pilate. ⁶³ “Sir,” they said, “we remember that while he was still alive that deceiver said, ‘After three days I will rise again.’” ⁶⁴ So give the order for the tomb to be made secure until the third day. Otherwise, his disciples may come and steal the body and tell the people that he has been raised from the dead. This last deception will be worse than the first.” ⁶⁵ “Take a guard,” Pilate answered. “Go, make the tomb as secure as you know how.” ⁶⁶ So they went and made the tomb secure by putting a seal on the stone and posting the guard.

¹ After the Sabbath, at dawn on the first day of the week, Mary Magdalene and the other Mary went to look at the tomb. ² There was a violent earthquake, for an angel of the Lord came down from heaven and, going to the tomb, rolled back the stone and sat on it. ³ His appearance was like lightning, and his clothes were white as snow. ⁴ The guards were so afraid of him that they shook and became like dead men. ⁵ The angel said to the women, “Do not be afraid, for I know that you are looking for Jesus, who was crucified. ⁶ He is not here; he has risen, just as he said. Come and see the place where he lay.

⁷ Then go quickly and tell his disciples: ‘He has risen from the dead and is going ahead of you into Galilee. There you will see him.’ Now I have told you.” ⁸ So the women hurried away from the tomb, afraid yet filled with joy, and ran to tell his disciples. ⁹ Suddenly Jesus met them. “Greetings,” he said. They came to him, clasped his feet and worshiped him. ¹⁰ Then Jesus said to them, “Do not be afraid. Go and tell my brothers to go to Galilee; there they will see me.”

Jesus was truly buried. Jesus truly rose again.

The resurrection confirms His victory over sin, His victory over death, and His identity as Lord.

Without the resurrection, the Cross would only be a tragedy. Because of the resurrection, it is our hope.

What Sin Cost Him

ISAIAH 53:4–6 NIV

⁴ Surely he took up our pain
and bore our suffering,
yet we considered him punished by God,
stricken by him, and afflicted.

⁵ But he was pierced for our transgressions,
he was crushed for our iniquities;
the punishment that brought us peace was on him,
and by his wounds we are healed.

⁶ We all, like sheep, have gone astray,
each of us has turned to our own way;
and the Lord has laid on him
the iniquity of us all.

Follow in His Steps

1 PETER 2:21–24 NIV

²¹ To this you were called, because Christ suffered for you, leaving you an example, that you should follow in his steps.

²² “He committed no sin,
and no deceit was found in his mouth.”

²³ When they hurled their insults at him, he did not retaliate; when he suffered, he made no threats. Instead, he entrusted himself to him who judges justly. ²⁴ “He himself bore our sins” in his body on the cross, so that we might die to sins and live for righteousness; “by his wounds you have been healed.”

The Cross is not only something to admire. It is something that should change us.

The right response is gratitude, confession, repentance, and a desire to live differently.

What is the hardest sin you need to surrender?

Answer Honestly

What does the Cross reveal about my sin?

Do I truly hate my sin because of how it hurt Jesus?

Am I following Jesus closely, or only at a distance?

Am I more like Peter, Judas, or Pilate?

What is one sin I need to confess and surrender?

CHALLENGE

- 01 Die to sin and live for righteousness.
- 02 Respond to the Cross with gratitude.
- 03 Take time for honest confession.
- 04 Develop a clear plan for repentance.
- 05 Choose a faithful response to Jesus.

PRAYER

Lord Jesus,

Thank You for Your sacrifice on the Cross. Help me never to treat
sin lightly.

Teach me to hate what separates me from You and to love You more
because of what You have done for me. Give me a broken heart, true
repentance, and a life that honors Your sacrifice.

Amen.

Closing Reflection

As you finish this guide, take time to reflect honestly before God.

What have you learned about Him?

What truth has challenged you the most?

What area of your life needs surrender or change?

What step of obedience is God asking from you now?

NEXT **Next Steps**

If you believe you are ready to take this step, we encourage you to speak with a pastor or church leader.

- Continue reading the Bible daily.
- Pray and seek God consistently.
- Join the church in worship and fellowship.
- Stay connected with other believers.
- Speak with a pastor or leader about your spiritual journey.
- Show your readiness to obey Christ in water baptism.

This guide is only the beginning. Keep growing in faith, truth, obedience, and love.

ACTS 2:42 · NIV

42 They devoted themselves to the apostles' teaching and to fellowship, to the breaking of bread and to prayer.

Acts 242 Church of Christ

4707 Dr Arcadio Santos Ave, Parañaque, 1700 Metro Manila

acts242churchofchrist.com